

LG's 18-inch flexible display

The company's flexible OLED 18-inch display screen is shown being folded up on itself
<http://dgit.in/LGFlexDisp>



Biggest Man-made Hole

The Bingham Canyon Mine in the US is 2.5 miles wide and more than half a mile deep, and can be seen from the ISS
<http://dgit.in/ManMadeHole>

Android smartphones



Intex Aqua Curve Mini

an attractive design thanks to its cobalt-coloured body and a bright 5-inch 720p display. The overall finish of the handset is worth the money and we were happy to see iBall bringing in something attractive for the consumers.

The Micromax Unite 2 has a surprisingly smart looking design with a rubberized plastic back and a full glass plate on the front. Under the protective glass, we have a 4.7-inch display with an 800x480 pixel resolution. The display is an IPS panel and the protective glass over the display gathers a lot of fingerprints and smudges which means you end up cleaning the display once every hour or so. Viewing angles are pretty average, with slight wash in colours when viewed from the sides and frankly speaking, a 720p resolution would have been perfect. The size of the device fits perfectly well in the hand, although, it does feel slightly heavy. The rubberized back gives a nice grip and one hand operations are easy.

For the ones who love to have a physical keyboard, we have added the Spice Stellar 360 which is a touch and type Android smartphone with a full QWERTY keyboard and a 3.5-inch display. The build quality is, however, not that good and the plastics are very glossy. The keyboard does take time to get used to (since we have become accustomed to the touchscreen) and when it comes to practical usage it works well. This could have been a very attractive smartphone if Spice had used better quality of materials.

Taiwan based handset maker HTC has also plunged into the affordable smartphone game by bringing in handsets that don't hurt your pocket all that much. In doing so, the company has compromised on features as well as build quality. The Desire 310 is one of the cheaper options available from HTC and for a budget handset it doesn't look very shabby. The display is a 4.5-inch panel with an 854x480 pixels resolution but surprisingly you don't get



HTC Desire 310 Dual SIM



Lava Iris X1

a light sensor so there is no automatic brightness setting, neither do you get a flash with the primary 5MP camera. HTC has saved its costs by missing out some of the small things that do matter.

For under ₹10,000 the Q1000 Opus looks quite sturdy. It has a very average design and build quality. The back is made out of glossy plastic and a chrome plated edge surrounds the handset. The display offers decent brightness levels although the resolution at 854x480, means pixel density is just 196 ppi, which is quite low for a 5-inch display panel. The touchscreen response is smooth and the hardware keys work perfectly well. The weight and dimensions of the Q1000 Opus seem slightly greater than most of the 5-inch devices out there. But the overall build quality of the smartphone, however, is not so bad in terms of product finish and quality of material.

The looks are quite similar to the Moto G, featuring a plastic design and a curved back with rubberized finish. The back

panels are changeable and one can choose from a variety of colours. There is a 4.3-inch LCD with a 960x540 resolution. For the ones who crave a 720p display, you won't be disappointed as the sharpness of the display is quite good. One hand operations are much easier and the handset fits pretty well in the hand. The design and form factor of the Moto E is good for the price it comes at, although it is a bit on the heavy side.

PERFORMANCE

Before jumping onto the hardware performance, let's talk about something that we have been asked about a number of times, "how good is the battery backup?" To determine the capability of the battery and the efficiency of the OS to utilise that battery, we have a simple battery test.

Every smartphone is charged to a full 100 per cent and then we play a full HD video for one hour on the smartphone. The brightness of the display is kept at high and we also keep the smartphone connected to Wi-Fi. Once that is complete, we check the amount of battery that has



Lava Iris 405+